

Software Installation Policy

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Policy Owner	Head of IT
Department	Information Technology
Approved By	Chief Operating Officer
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1. Purpose

This policy controls what software can be installed on Beacon devices, so that licences are respected and systems are not exposed to malware or legal risk.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all software, browser extensions and cloud (SaaS) tools used on company laptops or with company data.

3. Main Rules

3.1 Approved Software Catalogue

- IT maintains the Beacon Software Catalogue, which lists approved software.
- Employees may request any software from the catalogue through the IT Service Desk portal. Free catalogue software is installed within 2 working days without further approval.
- Paid catalogue software needs approval from the reporting manager. The purchase follows BT-FIN-005 (Purchase Approval Policy). Software costing more than ₹25,000 per year needs Department Head approval.

3.2 Software Not in the Catalogue

- A request must be raised with the business reason. IT Security will review it within 5 working days.
- Open-source software used in Beacon products must also be reviewed by the Legal team for licence terms.

3.3 Cloud and SaaS Tools

- Cloud tools that store or process company or customer data (for example, file sharing, note-taking, AI assistants or design tools) need a security assessment and Department Head approval before use.
- Personal cloud storage and personal email must not be used to store company data.
- SaaS subscriptions must not be charged to a corporate card without IT approval (BT-FIN-003).

3.4 Administrator Rights

- Employees do not have administrator rights on their laptops by default.
- Developers and technical staff may request temporary administrator rights through the Service Desk. Access is given for up to 30 days and can be renewed. Developers may be given up to 90 days, with manager approval.

3.5 Prohibited Software

The following must not be installed:

- Pirated or cracked software
- Torrent and file-sharing tools
- Unapproved VPN, proxy or remote-desktop tools
- Cryptocurrency miners
- Games and entertainment apps
- Hacking or network scanning tools, unless the user is in the Security team

3.6 Licence Management and Audits

- IT conducts software audits every quarter.
- Software that is unapproved or unlicensed is removed, and the employee's manager is informed.
- Paid licences that have not been used for 60 days are taken back and reassigned.

4. Exceptions

- The Information Security Officer may approve limited exceptions for testing and research with a defined end date.
- Teams working on client sites may use client-specified software where the client contract requires it, with approval from the Head of IT.

Internal Use Only

Beacon Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Synthetic document created for a technology prototype.